UNIT 11 ESSENTIALS OF CUSTOMER SERVICE

Structure

11.0 Objectives

11.1 Warm Up

11.2 Listening: Customer Service

11.3 Vocabulary

11.4 Reading - I: Good Customer Service Made Simple

11.5 Reading - II: Moments of Truth

11.6 Speaking

11.7 Writing

11.8 Grammar: Linkers

11.9 Pronunciation: Stress and Rhythm in Connected Speech - II: Weak Forms

11.10 Let Us Sum Up

11.11 Answers

11.0 OBJECTIVES

This Unit will familiarize you with the essentials of customer service. Here you will learn:

- What is customer service
- The importance of good customer service
- How we can make our customer service exceptional
- The importance of word-of-mouth publicity
- The importance of customer loyalty
- Qualities of a good customer service executive

11.1 WARM UP

Think of all the times you have gone to a store and have been confronted with a salesman whose attitude you found helpful and encouraging, and another whose attitude you found rude and unfriendly, or listless to the point of being discouraging. Which of these are you likely to pay a repeat visit to? Would the same logic apply whether the executive you were dealing with was speaking to you over the telephone?

Activity 1

Now think of all the qualities you would like a good sales person or customer service executive to have.

11.2 LISTENING: CUSTOMER SERVICE

Listen to a talk on customer service and then answer the questions in the exercise below.

Check your progress 1

1) How would you define good customer service?

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

2) Is good customer service dependent on the salesperson alone?

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

3) Why is it essential to build a relationship with your customer?

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

4) What is the likely fallout of a bad experience of a customer?

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

5) What, according to the text, is the one thing that is essential for a business to run profitably?

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

11.3 VOCABULARY

Activity 2

Following are words describing character traits a person can have. List these as positive or negative for a customer service executive.

1) soft-spoken
2) gently persuasive
3) encouraging
4) aggressive
5) loud
6) a good listener
7) talkative
8) pushy
9) defensive
10) offensive
11) attentive
12) well informed about the product
13) one who interrupts
14) well mannered
15) politely firm
16) rigid
17) pleasant
18) disinterested
19) markets aggressively
20) speaks clearly

11.4 READING - I: GOOD CUSTOMER SERVICE MADE SIMPLE

How do you go about forming a relationship with your customers? By remembering the one true secret of good customer service and acting accordingly;

"You will be judged by what you do, not what you say."

If you truly want to have good customer service, all you have to do is ensure that your business consistently does these things:

1) Answer your phone

Get call forwarding or an answering service. Hire staff if you need to. But make sure that someone is picking up the phone when someone calls your business. (Notice I say "someone". People who call want to talk to a live person, not a "fake recorded message".)

2) Don't make promises unless you will keep them

Reliability is one of the keys to any good relationship, and good customer service is no exception. If you say, "Your new bedroom furniture will be delivered on Tuesday", make sure it is delivered on Tuesday. Otherwise, don't say it. The same rule applies to client appointments, deadlines, etc. Think before you give any promise – because nothing annoys customers more than a broken one.

3) Listen to your customers

Is there anything more exasperating than telling someone what you want or what your problem is and then discovering that that person hasn't been paying attention and needs to have it explained again? From a customer's point of view, I doubt it. Let your customer talk and show him/her that you are listening by making the appropriate responses, such as suggesting how to solve the problem.

4) Deal with complaints

No one likes hearing complaints, and many of us have developed a reflex shrug, saying, "You can't please all the people all the time". Maybe not, but if you give the complaint your attention, you may be able to please this one person this one time - and position your business to reap the benefits of good customer service.

5) Be helpful - even if there's no immediate profit in it

The other day I went into a local watch shop because I had lost the small piece that clips the pieces of my watch band together. When I explained the problem, the proprietor said that he thought he might have one lying around. He found it, attached it to my watch band – and charged me nothing! Where do you think I'll go when I need a new watch band or even a new watch? And how many people do you think I've told this story to?

6) Take the extra step

For instance, if someone walks into your store and asks you to help them find something, don't just say, "It's in the left hand shelf." Lead the customer to the item. Better yet, wait and see if he has questions about it, or further needs. Whatever the extra step may be, if you want to provide good customer service, take it. They may not say so to you, but people notice when people make an extra effort and will tell other people.

7) Throw in something extra

Whether it's a coupon for a future discount, additional information on how to use the product, or a genuine smile, people love to get more than they thought

they were getting. And don't think that a gesture has to be large to be effective. The local photographer that we use gives a small photo album with the set of pictures he prints. A small thing, but so appreciated.

If you apply these simple rules consistently, your business will become known for its good customer service. And the best part? The irony of good customer service is that over time it will bring in more new customers than promotions and price slashing ever did!

by Susan Ward, About.com

Link: http://sbinfocanada.about.com/od/customerservice/a/custservrules.htm

Check your progress 2

Mark the following statements as true or false, according to the author of the text above.

i) People prefer speaking to a 'live' person rather than a recorded voice.

ii) You should try to keep the promise you made to your client.

iii) When a customer talks, you should only listen, and make no sound.

iv) Don't let the customer's complaint worry you because you cannot please all of them.

v) Give some help free of charge; this will encourage the customer to come back to you.

vi) Customers don't like it if you walk with them and try to explain everything about the product they show an interest in.

vii) It is a good idea to give customers information of attractive offers for the future.

viii) Overall, cutting down prices and having promotion drives brings in more new customers.

11.5 READING - II: MOMENTS OF TRUTH

A "moment of truth" is that point in time when the customer comes in contact with an aspect of your organization and forms an impression, positive or negative, about the quality of service you provide. This is why the "Moment of Truth" is also an opportunity for you to create a lasting positive impression in your customer's mind.

Take, for example, the time you went to a restaurant with your two-year old and the waiter ushered you to a table and immediately fetched a high chair for your child. Or when you were peering at the menu he appeared with a pair of reading glasses. Both of these are moments of truth you are going to carry with you.

Yet it is not as if there is one such moment with each customer. In fact the relationship you build with customers is actually laid brick by brick by several such moments at different stages in your interaction with them. These moments may come via phone calls, in-person contacts, letters, email, brochures/fliers, web sites, advertising, etc. But each one is equally important. For instance in the

example of the restaurant, you may have another moment where you are served the wrong order and the waiter takes it away but without an apology. That's your negative "Moment of Truth" that has every chance of wiping out the good impression that the previous moments created. A customer doesn't say, "Well, I have had five contacts with the company. Two were bad but three have been good, so they must be all right." Most customers are influenced by the most recent contact. If it was bad, they feel negatively about your company, no matter how many positive moments they may have experienced before it. Hence every contact you have with a customer is as much an opportunity to undo all the good that previous contacts have built up and maybe lose the customer, as it is to undo the bad impression that the customer may have of the company, and regain his trust.

Remember that customers don't read your company's customer service policy statement, or look at its balance sheets to decide whether it is customer oriented. They do this purely on the basis of the contacts they have had with it. These contacts may be at different moments in time, and each of these "moments" determines their impression of the company.

Managing Moments of Truth

So what can you do to ensure that these moments make a positive impact on customers? To manage a Moment of Truth favourably, you need to exhibit care and concern at all times to prove to customers that you personally value their business and that you are prepared to put yourself out for them, by sorting out complicated arrangements on their behalf, for example. Additionally, if you are well informed about the policies of your organization, and about what liberties you can take to make on-the-spot decisions, you are less likely to tell a customer that you will get back after consulting your superior – a reaction no customer relishes. Customers always want problems resolved quickly and efficiently. While handling a problem, see that there is no passing the buck, making excuses, or any attempt to ignore even a part of the problem – all of these can make the "Moment of Truth" go horribly wrong.

To ensure that each one of your "Moments" goes off favourably, "own the problem" and regard it as your personal responsibility to see that consumers or customers are satisfied.

Your action plan

Your actions:

- Crisis management
- Authority levels
- Initiative
- Recommendations to your manager

How to Handle Moments of Truth

Companies that handle Moments of Truth well will tend to have the following five characteristics:

1) Performance at every contact point is assessed against the consumers' criteria. This includes, for example, first impressions of the company building / shop / lounge etc., mailings, standard letters and so on.

2) Staff who "own the problem" and regard it as their personal responsibility to see that consumers or customers are satisfied.

3) They have clearly defined and well understood crisis management procedures so that staff knows how to handle problems in such a way that the problem is taken from the consumer and replaced with a solution. As one insurance company puts it, if you give them your business they will never make a drama out of a crisis.

4) Authority levels facilitate spontaneity and recovery.

5) The management style and methods of control encourage staff to use their initiative to serve the company well.

Moments of Truth – Conclusions

- Consumer service survival requires you not to retreat and distance yourself from the customer.

- You have to get even more sincere and authentic than you normally are. The customer wants someone to really listen to him and appreciate his predicament.

- The customer wants you to do battle for them not against them. That's the basis for long term successful consumer service: *Building the Relationship.*

- **First impressions**: First impressions are made in 30 seconds – about the place, about the people

    - *about the place…* you may notice: cleanliness, orderliness, spaciousness, lighting, sound, pleasant or unpleasant odours, furnishings…

    - *about the people…* you may notice: if they are smiling, if they seem harried, how they are dressed, if they seem to be working together or apart from one another…

All of these put together make a strong first (and sometimes lasting) impression.

Difficult Customer Behaviour

- We all have personal triggers. It's important to realize what a customer might do that could cause us to "turn off" or not handle an encounter well.

- Behaviours many people find hard to deal with include: yelling, profanity, finger pointing, name calling, body odour, peculiar dress, name dropping, etc.

Think of a few behaviours you might find annoying or difficult to handle; write down how you would manage that behaviour positively.

Our example…

Behaviour: A customer yells at me.

Response: I tell the person in a calm voice that her raised voice upsets me and I will be able to help her more effectively, if she doesn't raise her voice.

Check your progress 3

Now note down how you would respond to customer behaviour in the following situations:

1) **Customer behaviour**: A customer shows impatience and demands your immediate attention

Your response:

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

2) **Customer behaviour**: At a restaurant, a customer is annoyed that s/he has been served the wrong order.

Your response:

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

3) **Customer behaviour**: At a restaurant, a customer is unhappy with his table.

Your response:

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

4) **Customer behaviour**: A customer is keen on chatting, but you need to disconnect the phone.

Your response:

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

5) **Customer behaviour**: A customer is annoyed that a product hasn't been delivered by the promised date.

Your response:

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

11.6 SPEAKING

Activity 3

An impatient customer is waiting to be attended to at a car showroom. His temper is building.

Complete the following dialogue between the customer and the sales representative and then enact it with a partner.



Customer: (Impatiently) Excuse me, I'd like to know when somebody is going to attend to us!

Executive: Just a moment, Sir.

Customer: What! I've already been …….

.....

.....

.....

.....

For further speaking practice, you could make up dialogues for the situations in **Check your progress 3** and enact them with a partner.

11.7 WRITING

Activity 4

Write down the points about further improving your customer service, particularly focusing on what you can do after having sold your service/ product. Now take a look at the answer key and see how many of these match with yours and how many are new to you. Discuss these with the others around you.

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

11.8 GRAMMAR: LINKERS

Linkers, as you may already know, are also called connectives, and they illustrate how parts of a text relate to each other. They help to link clauses, sentences, paragraphs and ideas together to show the logical development of what the writer or speaker wants to say.

They are used for adding information to the main point, contrasting ideas, expressing cause and effect, expressing purpose and opinion, in sequencing, listing examples, making conclusions and giving emphasis. **You will find several examples in the listening audio script.**

Tabled below are some of the functions which linking words fulfill.

FUNCTION	LINKING WORDS/CONNECTIVES
a) For addition	and, as well as, besides, moreover, furthermore, what is more, in addition, not only .... but also, another point is that, additionally

b) For contrasting	but, however, although, despite, in spite of, nevertheless, on the contrary, on the one hand, on the other hand, whereas, while, in contrast, neither...nor
c) For expressing cause or reason	because, as, since, this is why, because of, due to, owing to, for this reason,
d) For expressing result	hence, therefore, thus, consequently, as a result
e) For expressing opinion	I would say that, in my opinion, I think (that), I believe (that), personally, apparently
f) For expressing purpose	to, so as to, in order that, so that
g) In sequencing	first (of all), at first, in the beginning, to begin with, then, next, secondly, before, after, after that, afterwards, when, soon, prior to, immediately, once, suddenly, as soon as, no sooner....than, hardly...when, finally, eventually, at the end, in the end, at last, until, lastly
h) For summing up/concluding	all in all, overall, generally, in conclusion, on the whole, in the main, to sum up
i) For emphasis	especially, particularly, naturally, exactly because, above all, whatever, whenever
j) For giving examples	for example, for instance, for one thing, this includes, such as, e.g. (for example), i.e. (that is)

Check Your Progress 4

1) Now go back to the audio script of the Listening section, and with your partner find the connectives for addition and those for contrasting in it.

.....

.....

2) Complete the following paragraph by inserting the right linking device in each blank space.

..... online commerce has become quite popular over the years, many people still like to go out shopping. What gives them satisfaction is the entire process of making the shopping list, getting ready for the outing, and the shopping itself. ..... fulfilling their need to buy things, it also serves as an outing.

....., many are of the opinion that they want to see and touch products to get a better feel and idea of them before making their decision to buy. ....., ..., if one wants to buy new upholstery for the sofas, or even a pair of trousers, how can one get the feel of the fabric without physically touching it?

....., there are others who believe that online shopping is a blessing. ..... their busy work life, they have neither time nor energy to go out shopping. ..... is it convenient, ... saves time and effort.

....., it's each one to his own. So either way, happy shopping!

11.9 PRONUNCIATION: STRESS AND RHYTHM IN CONNECTED SPEECH II: WEAK FORMS

Rhythm refers to the recurrence of an event at regular periods of time. The rhythm of English speech depends on the stressed syllables occurring at regular intervals of time. This is easy in a sentence like:

'Go and 'post this 'card.

because in this sentence there is one stressed syllable, then one unstressed syllable, and then one stressed syllable, and so on. Let us take another sentence.

The 'boy you 'met on 'Monday 'came to 'see you.

Once again, in this sentence, stressed syllables occur regularly, one after every weak syllable, but there is a slight pause after 'Monday'. In the sentence that we use in our everyday speech, the stressed syllables may not occur so regularly. Take the sentence

He is a pro'fessor of Mathe'matics at the Uni'versity of 'Delhi.

There are four stressed syllables (which have been marked). There are four unstressed syllables before the first stressed syllable, four unstressed syllables between the first and the second stressed syllables, five unstressed syllables between the second and the third stressed syllables, and three unstressed syllables between the last two stressed syllables. Given below is another example.

'John's 'friend 'Ram / 'visited him on the o'ccasion of his 'birthday.

In the sentence given above, four stressed syllables occur together without any unstressed syllable between them but there is a slight pause after 'Ram'. Between the fourth and the fifth stressed syllables, there are six unstressed syllables, and between the fifth and the sixth stressed syllables, there are three unstressed syllables.

How can we make the stressed syllables occur at regular intervals of time, if they don't occur regularly in an utterance, as the two sentences given above illustrate?

When there are too many unstressed syllables between two stressed syllables, we have to say them quickly and use the r*educed* or *weak forms* of some of the words. In weak syllables the vowels generally used are /ə/, /ɪ/ and /ʊ/. Sometimes we also leave out certain sounds – don't pronounce them at all.

Given below is a list of the weak forms of some common English words. The strong form is used when the word is said in isolation or is stressed. In the case of verbs and prepositions, the strong form is also used when the word comes at the end of the sentence. **You can listen to all the examples of weak forms on the audio recording.**

Word Class	Word	Strong form	Weak Form	Examples of a phrase or a sentence with the weak form
Articles	a	/eɪ/	/ ə /	It's a 'book.
	an	/æn/	/ ən /	He 'ate an 'apple.
	the	/ði: /	/ ðɪ / (before vowels)	The 'eighth of 'June.
			/ ðə / (before consonants)	The 'book's 'here.
Auxiliary or helping verbs (and linking or connecting verbs)	am	/æm/	/m/	I'm 'going to 'Delhi. I'm a 'teacher.
	are	/a:/	/ə/	They're 'going.
	can	/ kæn /	/ kən /	Can I 'go 'now?
Prepositions	at	/æt/	/ət/	I 'met him at the 'Post 'Office.
	for	/f ɔ:/	/fə(r)/	I 'did it for my 'mother.
Conjunctions	and	/ænd/	/ənd/ (before vowels) /ən/ (before consonants)	'Over and a'bove 'Butter and 'jam
	as	/æz/	/əz/	As 'soon as I 'can.
Pronouns	he	/hi:/	/hɪ/ (after pause or vowels), /ɪ/ (after consonants)	He 'told me. Is he 'here?
	her	/hɜ:/	/hə(r)/ (possessive)	Her 'aunt's come.

A very important point to remember is that the weak forms of prepositions and auxiliary and linking verbs are **not** used when they occur at the end of a sentence. The sentence:

Where are you from?

cannot end with the weak form / frəm / . It has to end with the strong form /frɒm/.

Similarly, 'Who's coming?' /hu:z k∧miŋ/ 'ɪ am' / aɪ æm / . (Note the strong form of *am*)

Check Your Progress 5

Mark the stressed syllables in the following sentences. In some cases you may have to divide the sentence into groups. Check your answers with those given at the end of this unit. After you have checked your answers, say the sentences with the correct stress patterns. You can also listen to these sentences on the audio recording.

1) He's a good painter.
2) She's a nice girl.
3) Jack and Jill went to get some water.
4) It's a very beautiful building.
5) The Prime Minister of France is quite dynamic.
6) Can I see you at ten?
7) I'm afraid I'm very late today.
8) My father is a retired engineer.
9) The plane to London is delayed by two hours.
10) Can you get me a cup of tea?
11) He's extremely honest.
12) Honesty is the best policy.
13) He's a Professor of Physics.
14) Can a cobra swim?
15) My neighbour has an imported car.
16) Have you ever travelled by plane?
17) I worked in the States for two years.
18) Jackals are very cunning animals.
19) I have a working knowledge of Arabic.
20) It's impossible to please everybody.
21) What an enormous man!
22) She has a very pleasant personality.
23) Uncle Robert visited us yesterday.
24) Please bring me a chair.
25) Would you like anything to drink?

11.10 LET US SUM UP

We have learnt in this unit that customer service is a very important component of any business – for the client as well as the organization. For the client it brings greater satisfaction, trust in the organization, and a sense of loyalty that encourages him to come back.

For the business, a satisfied customer means good word-of-mouth publicity that will bring in new customers and repeated business from the same clients, both of which are cost-free promotions.

We have learnt also that good customer service involves every department of the business, not just face-to-face or telephonic contact with the customer.

11.11 ANSWERS

Audio text on Customer Service

What is customer service? Is it the ability to communicate to your customers all that your company can provide them, or is it something more than that? If it is something more, then what is that something?

In simple terms, customer service is an organization's ability to fulfill their customers' needs. But what makes an organization's customer service exceptional? Superior customer service is that which exceeds your customers' expectations and makes your business stand out from that of your competitors. What this essentially means is that every aspect of your business has an impact on what you finally deliver to your customer. Good customer service is not just limited to face-to-face customer contact with the person availing of your services, or telephonic conversation you may have with her/him while providing the service or product. From the moment a customer thinks of purchasing a product or service from you, then through the sales process, and the service you render thereafter, at every stage there are opportunities for an organization to add customer service to the product.

Although it's true that a good salesperson can sell anything to anyone once, you have to remember that good customer service is all about bringing the customer back. This s/he will do only if s/he goes away satisfied the first time, in which case you also hope that s/he will pass positive feedback about your business to others, who may then try the product or service you offer for themselves and in their turn become repeat customers. Word-of-mouth referral is the most effective form of promotion. It costs nothing and carries a lot of credibility as it is based on personal experience. On the other hand, a customer who has had a bad experience is likely to tell ten other people about it, who in all probability will pass on the information to as many more. It is not difficult to imagine how much damage bad publicity of this sort can do to a business. Additionally, it's important to remember that finding new customers is more expensive than retaining existing ones; and a lost customer is also lost revenue, not to mention the damage he will do to your reputation. So essentially, it will be your approach and attitude that determines whether a customer is ever likely to come back to you for something else. You need to win over your customer in a manner that builds a relationship with him/her – a relationship that an individual customer is comfortable with,

and feels that s/he would like to pursue. The bottom-line really is – you may slash prices, do sales promotions, or whatever else you can think of to bring in new customers – but the only way for your business to stay profitable is to bring back some of those customers.

Check your progress 1

1) Good customer service is that which exceeds your customers' expectations and makes your business stand out from that of your competitors.

2) No. it isn't. Every aspect of the business has an impact on customer service. Good customer service is not just limited to face-to-face customer contact with the person availing of your services, or telephonic conversation you may have with him/her while providing the service or product. From the moment a customer thinks of purchasing a product or service from you, then through the sales process, and the service you render thereafter, at every stage there are opportunities for an organization to add customer service to the product.

3) Building a relationship with the customer gives him/her a feeling of comfort and confidence, which in turn will in all probability result in him/her coming back for further business and recommending it to others.

4) A customer who has had a bad experience is likely to tell ten other people about it, who in all probability will pass on the information to as many more. This negative publicity cannot be good for any business.

5) One very important thing for a business to run successfully is for customers to come back to it for more.

Activity 2

POSITIVE	NEGATIVE
soft-spoken	aggressive
gently persuasive	loud
couraging	talkative
a good listener	pushy
attentive	defensive
well informed about the product	offensive
well mannered	one who interrupts
politely firm	rigid
pleasant	disinterested
speaks clearly	markets aggressively

Check your progress 2

i) People prefer speaking to a 'live' person rather than a recorded voice. **True**.

ii) You should try to keep the promise you made to your client. **False You must keep the promise you made to your client.**

iii) When a customer talks, you should only listen, and make no sound. **False**.

Listen keenly, but show him that you are listening by making the appropriate responses, such as suggesting how to solve the problem.

iv) Don't let the customer's complaint worry you because you cannot please all of them. **False**

Try to address the complaint. Even if you can please one customer with your handling of complaints, your business will reap the benefits of good customer service.

v) Give some help free of charge; this will encourage the customer to come back to you. **True**

vi) Customers don't like it if you walk with them and try to explain everything about the product they show an interest in. **False Customers like attentive staff.**

vii) It is a good idea to give customers information of attractive offers for the future. **True**

viii) Overall, cutting down prices and having promotion drives brings in more new customers. **False**

In the long run, good customer service brings in more new customers than either of these.

Check your progress 3

These are sample responses. Yours could be different, but they must be aimed at creating a positive impression on the customer.

1) **Your response**: In a calm voice, you tell the customer you understand that he is in a hurry, and will be with him as soon as you finish with the one you are dealing with, as he too has been waiting for some time. Meanwhile, you offer him a refreshment/seat.

2) **Your response**: You apologize for the mistake and immediately replace his order, and offer a free side dish.

3) **Your response**: You express understanding and change his table. If there is no empty table, you express your regret at not being able to do so, and try to understand what is causing him discomfort, and address the problem.

4) **Your response**: You tell him that what he is talking about sounds really interesting, but you need to carry on with your job.

5) **Your response:** You express your regret and apologize, and assure him that it will be done at the earliest. Offer an additional free service to make up for the inconvenience**.**

Activity 3

This is one way you could develop the dialogue. Yours could be different.

Customer: (Impatiently) Excuse me, I'd like to know when somebody is going to attend to us!

Executive: Just a moment, Sir.

Customer: What! I've already been waiting for twenty minutes.

Executive: My apologies. Please give me a minute. I'll get somebody to attend to you.

Customer: Oh! Somebody else told me that five minutes ago.

Executive: Here, Sir. Take a look at these brochures and I'll join you as soon as I get done with this billing. And I apologize again for the inconvenience. Meanwhile, could I offer you something to drink?

Customer: (Satisfied) Thank you, young man.

Activity 4

These are only sample answers; yours could be different.

1) Make follow-up calls to the customers to see if the service/product is working well.
2) Ensure that all free services in future are delivered on time.
3) Provide feedback forms for your customers to complete.
4) Pay special attention to negative feedback.
5) Keep a list of customer complaints to identify any patterns and the cause of dissatisfaction.
6) Take effective steps to address common complaints in the list.
7) Take testimonials of good service from satisfied customers.

Check your progress 4

2) Completed paragraph with linkers:

Although online commerce has become quite popular over the years, many people still like to go out shopping. What gives them satisfaction is the entire process of making the shopping list, getting ready for the outing, and the shopping itself. **Besides/Other than** fulfilling their need to buy things, it also serves as an outing.

Additionally/Furthermore, many are of the opinion that they want to see and touch products to get a better feel and idea of them before making their decision to buy. **Especially**, **for instance/for example**, if one wants to buy new upholstery for the sofas, or even a pair of trousers, how can one get the feel of the fabric without physically touching it?

On the other hand/However, there are others who believe that online shopping is a blessing. **Owing to/Because of** their busy work life, they have neither time nor energy to go out shopping. **Not only** is it convenient, **but also** saves time and effort.

At the end, it's each one to his own. So either way, happy shopping!

Check Your Progress 5

Stress mark

1) He's a 'good 'painter.

2) She's a 'nice 'girl.
3) 'Jack and 'Jill / 'went to 'get some 'water. (division into groups shown by/)
4) It's a 'very 'beautiful 'building.
5) The 'Prime 'Minister of 'France / is 'quite dy'namic.
6) Can I 'see you at 'ten?
7) I'm a'fraid I'm 'very 'late to 'day.
8) My 'father is a re'tired engi'neer.
9) The 'plane to 'London / is de'layed by 'two hours.
10) Can you 'get me a 'cup of 'tea?
11) He is ex'tremely 'honest.
12) 'Honesty is the 'best 'policy.
13) He is a pro'fessor of 'Physics.
14) Can a 'cobra 'swim?
15) My 'neighbour has an im'ported 'car.
16) Have you 'ever 'traveled by 'plane?
17) I 'worked in the 'States for 'two 'years.
18) 'Jackals are 'very 'cunning 'animals.
19) I have a 'working 'knowledge of 'Arabic.
20) It's im'possible to 'please 'everybody.
21) 'What an e'normous 'man!
22) She has a 'very 'pleasant perso'nality.
23) 'Uncle 'Robert 'visited us 'yesterday.
24) 'Please 'bring me a 'chair.
25) Would you 'like 'anything to 'drink?